

Assosa University
College of Social Sciences and Humanities
Department of Civics and Ethical Studies

Time allowed 50 minutes

mid exam I (30%)

Critical Thinking

ID#

Section

Attention! Write only your ID number; do not write your name. Moreover, any act of dishonesty will not be tolerated.

And write your answer only on the colored space provided. check the backside

I. WRITE 'TRUE' IF THE STATEMENT IS CORRECT AND 'FALSE' IF IT IS WRONG (1 POINT EACH)

1. If a deductive argument has all true premises and a true conclusion, it is necessarily sound.
2. A passage can be argumentative if it lacks a claim that anything is being proved.

II. Choose the best answer from the given alternatives. (2 point each)

➤ Based on the argument below try to answer the two consecutive questions.

All planet in our solar system moves in an elliptical orbit around the sun

Jupiter is a planet

Therefore, Jupiter moves in an elliptical orbit around the sun

1. Which one is false regarding the above argument?
 - A. It is a valid deductive argument
 - B. it is an invalid argument
 - C. It is a sound argument
 - D. it has necessary inferential link
2. Which one is true about the above argument?
 - A. It is an invalid argument
 - B. it has probable inferential link
 - C. It is unsound
 - ☒ D. It is a sound argument

➤ Consider the following argument and try to answer the two consecutive questions.

From the dawn of recorded history, it has been reported that the sun rises everyday

Tomorrow is a day

Therefore, the sun will rise tomorrow.

3. Which one is false regarding the above argument?

- A. It is a strong inductive argument
- B. It is a weak argument
- C. It is a cogent argument
- D. It has probable inferential link

4. Which one is true about the above argument?

- A. it is a weak argument
- B. it has necessary inferential link
- C. it is uncogent
- D. It is a cogent argument

5. From the following passages, identify the typical kinds of *non-argument*.

- A. Abortion is morally wrong because it is wrong to take the life of an innocent human being, and a fetus is an innocent human being.
- B. Either the grand renaissance dam is situated in the state of Benishangul or in the state of Tigray. The grand renaissance dam is not situated in the state of Tigray. Therefore, it must be in the state of Benishangul.
- C. "Ethiopia has completed the filling of a massive, controversial dam on the Blue Nile river for a second year" Aljazeera 2021
- D. The answer is not given

6. Humans and chimpanzees each have pain receptors, neurological pain pathways within their brains, and natural pain killers. Humans consciously experience pain. Therefore, chimpanzees probably also consciously experience pain. What is the category of this argument?

- A. An argument from analogy.
- B. An argument from definition.
- C. An argument from signs.
- D. An argument from authority

7. In the expression "If the Big Bang theory is correct, then the universe is billions of years old," the statement "the Big Bang theory is correct" is called the:
 A. Conditional B. Consequent C. Explanandum D. Antecedent.
8. What is the category of the following reasoning?
 Either Leonardo da Vinci or Pablo Picasso painted the Mona Lisa.
 But it clearly wasn't da Vinci.
 Therefore, Pablo Picasso painted the Mona Lisa.
 A. Deduction: Categorical syllogism C. Induction: An argument from prediction
 B. Deduction: Disjunctive syllogism D. Induction: An argument from authority
9. Given that $2x - 1 = 13$. It follows that $x = 6$. What is the category of this argument?
 A. Invalid Deductive Argument B. Valid Deductive Argument
 C. strong Inductive Argument D. Weak Inductive Argument
10. Of the following fields of philosophy, in which we can find a wrong combination
 A. Metaphysics → the study of reality, existence, and being qua being.
 B. Epistemology → the study of theory of knowledge.
 C. Logic → the study of the principles of right reasoning
 D. Ethics → it is concerned with moral values that defines a code of values to guide man's choices and actions
 E. None
11. If a deductive argument has all false premises and false conclusion, then we know:
 A. The argument is invalid. B. The argument is valid.
 C. Nothing as such about the argument's validity. D. The argument is sound.
12. There's a fire in there because there is smoke out here. *What is the category of this argument?*
 A. An argument from analogy. B. Causal inferences.
 C. An argument from signs. D. An argument from authority
13. Most of the previous long-distance Olympic heroes were Ethiopian and Kenyan athletes. Therefore, probably Ethiopian and Kenyan athletes will win the next Olympic medal in the field. What is the category of this argument?
 A. Valid deductive argument B. Weak inductive argument
 C. Sound deductive argument D. Strong inductive argument

III. Fill the blank space (1 point each)

14. Breathable oxygen is a 27 human condition for humans to live.
 15. Getting a 100 is a _____ condition for getting an A.

[Answer key]

- T/F 1). _____ 2). _____
 Choice 1). _____ 2). _____ 3). _____ 4). _____ 5). _____ 6). _____ 7). _____ 8). _____ 9). _____
 10). _____ 11). _____ 12). _____ 13). _____
 Fill 14). _____
 15). _____